

Participant Information Sheet

Study title

Choosing the Preferred Music Mix for Different Listening Situations – An Online Listening Study

Version number and date

Version 0.1: 15/07/2026

Researcher's name

Georgios Velissaridis (Supervisor)

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Queen Mary Research Ethics Committee reference number:

QME26.0001

Invitation paragraph

You are invited to take part in a research study being conducted as part of an MSc dissertation at Queen Mary University of London.

Before deciding whether to participate, please read the following information carefully. It explains why the research is being carried out and what taking part involves.

Participation is entirely voluntary. If you decide not to participate, this will not affect you in any way.

What is the purpose of the study and what would taking part involve?

This study investigates how different versions of the same music are perceived in everyday listening situations. People often listen to music while studying, relaxing, exercising, travelling or carrying out other daily activities. The purpose of this study is to understand whether different mix versions of the same music are preferred depending on the listening context.

If you choose to take part, you will be randomly assigned to one of two participant groups. You will read five short listening scenarios describing everyday situations. For each scenario, you will listen to two short music excerpts, each presented in multiple mix versions. Using a continuous 0–100 scale, you will indicate how much you would prefer each mix version while imagining yourself in the listening situation described. You will also be asked to briefly explain the reason for your preference for each mix version.

The study is completed through a custom web-based interface and is expected to take approximately 15–20 minutes. No follow-up sessions are required.

The findings will contribute to research on listener-centred music technologies that aim to adapt music to different listening contexts and user preferences.

Why am I being invited?

You have been invited because you are aged 18 years or older and are interested in taking part in an online music listening study. No previous experience with music production or audio engineering is required.

Do I have to take part?

No. Participation is completely voluntary. You may withdraw from the study at any time before submitting your responses. After submission, it will no longer be possible to withdraw your data because your responses will be anonymised and cannot be linked back to you.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

There are no direct personal benefits from participating. However, your responses will help improve understanding of how people prefer different music mixes in different listening situations and may contribute to future research in music technology and artificial intelligence.

What are the possible disadvantages and risks of taking part?

This study is considered low risk. The main task involves listening to short music excerpts and answering questionnaire items. Some participants may experience minor listening fatigue. To minimise this risk:

- the study is designed to be short;
- all audio excerpts have been loudness-normalised to provide a consistent listening experience.;
- you may stop participating at any time;
- you are encouraged to use a comfortable listening volume.

Expenses and payments

There are no expenses associated with taking part in this study, as it is completed entirely online using the participant's own device and internet connection. No payment, reimbursement, or other form of compensation will be provided for participation.

What information about me will you be collecting?

The study will collect:

- your preference ratings for each mix version using a continuous 0–100 scale;
- your comments explaining the reasons for your preferences;
- your responses to the post-task questionnaire, including:
 - task immersion;
 - perceived task difficulty;
 - familiarity with the music excerpts;
 - headphones or earphones used;
 - location where you completed the study;
 - any additional comments about your experience;
- your age range;
- your gender (optional);
- your country or cultural background where you had the greatest influence on your musical preferences;
- your music listening habits;
- your experience with music production or audio engineering (if any);
- whether you report any hearing difficulty.

How will my data be stored and who will have access to it?

Your data will be stored in a fully anonymized format on secure servers, accessible to the research team and to other researchers that request it. No personal identifiers will be collected, ensuring that your responses cannot be linked back to you. Data will be encrypted and managed following Queen Mary's Data Protection Policy and Information/Data Governance Policy (DG14). Anonymized data may be retained for future research purposes in accordance with ethical guidelines.

When and how will my data be destroyed?

Your data will be securely stored in anonymised form for a period of five years in accordance with the Queen Mary Records Retention Schedule. After this period, your data will be

permanently deleted in accordance with Queen Mary University of London policies. If fully anonymised data is retained for future research purposes, it will remain impossible to identify individual participants.

How will my data be used and shared?

Your data may be part of publications in academic conferences, in fully anonymised format.

The data will be stored in a database accessible by others, per request to the research team.

Under what legal basis are you collecting this information?

- Queen Mary University of London **processes personal data** for research purposes in accordance with the lawful basis of 'public task'.
- Please read [Queen Mary's privacy notice for research participants](#) containing **important information about your personal data and your rights** in this respect.
- **If you have any questions** relating to data protection, please contact Queen Mary's Data Protection Officer, Queens' Building, Mile End Road, London, E1 4NS or data-protection@qmul.ac.uk or 020 7882 7596.

What will happen if I want to withdraw from this study?

You can withdraw from this study at any time during the data collection phase without providing a reason. If you choose to withdraw, any data you have provided will be confidentially destroyed and not used in the research. However, after submission, it will no longer be possible to withdraw your data as it will have been anonymised.

What should I do if I have concerns about this study?

- **If you have any concerns** about the manner in which the study was conducted, in the first instance, please **contact the researcher(s)** responsible for the study

Georgios Velissaridis, g.velissaridis@qmul.ac.uk

- **If you have a complaint** which you feel you cannot discuss with the researchers then you should **contact the Research Ethics Facilitators** by e-mail: research-ethics@qmul.ac.uk.
- When contacting the Research Ethics Facilitators, **please provide details** of the study title, description the study and QM REC reference number (where possible), the researcher(s) involved, and details of the complaint you wish to make.

Who can I contact if I have any questions about this study?

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